

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Time Tracking & Billing Application

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1. Executive Summary

This document outlines the product requirements for a cross-platform time tracking and billing application. The application enables individuals, teams, and managers to efficiently log billable and non-billable hours against projects and clients, generate professional invoices, and analyze productivity data — all from a lightweight, always-accessible desktop widget experience.

2. Goals & Objectives

- Provide a **fast, low-friction** time tracking experience accessible from the OS taskbar
- Enable **accurate billing and invoicing** tied directly to tracked time
- Give **managers visibility** into team contributions across projects
- Support **scalable team management** with role-based access and approval workflows
- Integrate with **existing tools** (calendars, project management, accounting software)
- Ensure **enterprise-grade security** and compliance

3. Target Users

User Type	Description
Individual Contributor	Tracks their own time against assigned projects
Manager	Oversees team time logs, approves entries, monitors project budgets
Admin	Manages accounts, billing, integrations, and system settings

User Type	Description
Client (View-Only)	Read-only portal access to view project progress and invoices

4. Platform & Availability

Platform	Delivery Method
Windows	Taskbar widget + full desktop application
macOS	Menu bar widget + full desktop application
iOS / Android	Native mobile application
Web Browser	Browser extension + full web application
Offline Support	Full timer functionality offline; auto-sync on reconnect

5. Feature Requirements

5.1 Taskbar / Menu Bar Widget

Description: A lightweight, always-visible entry point to the application living in the Windows taskbar or macOS menu bar.

Requirements:

- Clicking the widget opens a compact **Quick Launch Interface**
 - Widget displays **today's total tracked hours** without opening the full app
 - Supports **dark and light mode** rendering
 - Widget remains accessible during full app use
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5.2 Quick Launch Interface (Widget Popup)

Description: A small popup interface for starting or resuming a time tracking session quickly.

5.2.1 Existing Session Start

- User selects from a **dropdown of existing projects**
- **Client name** auto-populates based on selected project
- **Date auto-fills** to current date (editable)
- **"Start" button** initiates the timer

5.2.2 New Session Creation

- User clicks the "**⊕**" (**plus-circle**) **button** to create a new session
 - Required fields:
 - Project Title
 - Client Name
 - Quick Description
 - Date (*auto-filled, editable*)
 - **"Start" button** initiates the timer upon completion
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5.3 Active Timer Interface

Description: The interface displayed while a session timer is actively running.

Requirements:

- Displays **live running timer** (HH:MM:SS)
- Displays active **project title** and **client name**
- Three action buttons available at all times:

Button Behavior

Pause Pauses the timer; resumes on click

Cancel Triggers a warning popup: *"Are you sure you want to cancel this session? All time will be lost."* with **Proceed** and **Go Back** options

Finish Stops the timer and opens the **Session Summary Screen**

5.4 Session Summary Screen

Description: Displayed after clicking "Finish." Allows the user to confirm or discard the session.

Requirements:

- Displays **total time duration** of the session
- Displays **project title, client name, date, and description**
- Two action buttons:

Button Behavior

Confirm Saves the session to the user's account and dashboard

Cancel Triggers a warning popup: *"Are you sure you want to discard this session?"* with **Proceed** and **Go Back** options

- Option to mark session as **Billable** or **Non-Billable** before confirming
 - Option to **edit time manually** before confirming
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5.5 Idle Detection

Description: Automatically detects user inactivity and pauses the timer accordingly.

Requirements:

- Detects absence of keyboard/mouse activity after a **configurable threshold** (default: 10 minutes)
 - Displays prompt: *"You've been idle for X minutes — keep or discard idle time?"*
 - Options: **Keep Idle Time, Discard Idle Time, Resume Timer**
 - Idle threshold configurable per user in account settings
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5.6 Manual Time Entry

Description: Allows users to log time retroactively without using the live timer.

Requirements:

- Accessible from both the widget and the full dashboard
 - Fields:
 - Project (existing or new)
 - Client Name
 - Date
 - Start Time
 - End Time (*duration auto-calculates*)
 - Description
 - Billable / Non-Billable toggle
 - Saved entries appear identically to timer-generated sessions in the dashboard
 - Manual entries are **flagged visually** (e.g., pencil icon) for manager review distinction
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5.7 Time Rounding

Description: Optional rounding of session durations to standard billing increments.

Requirements:

- User-configurable rounding options:
 - No rounding
 - Nearest 6 minutes
 - Nearest 10 minutes
 - Nearest 15 minutes
 - Rounding preference set per user or per project
 - Rounded time displayed at session confirmation with original time shown for reference
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5.8 Multiple Concurrent Timers

Description: Allows users to run and switch between multiple active timers simultaneously.

Requirements:

- Up to **5 concurrent timers** supported
 - Widget displays the **currently active timer**; others are paused automatically when switching
 - All active timers visible in a **stacked mini-view** within the widget popup
 - Each timer independently supports Pause, Cancel, and Finish actions
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5.9 Full Application Dashboard

Description: The primary user interface for viewing, managing, and analyzing all time tracking data.

Requirements:

5.9.1 Overview Panel

- Displays **recent sessions** (last 7 days by default)
- Summary cards showing:
 - Total hours this week
 - Total billable hours this week
 - Total non-billable hours this week
 - Number of active projects

5.9.2 Session Management

- Full list of all logged sessions
- **Filterable** by:
 - Date range
 - Client
 - Project
 - Employee (*managers only*)
 - Billing status (Billable / Non-Billable / Invoiced)
- **Editable** sessions (with audit trail)

- **Drag-and-drop** session reassignment to different projects or dates

5.9.3 Project Views

- Individual project pages showing:
 - All sessions logged against the project
 - Total hours to date
 - Budget vs. Actual hours progress bar
 - Team member contributions (*managers only*)
 - Billing status summary

5.9.4 Visual Analytics

- Charts and graphs including:
 - Hours per project (bar chart)
 - Hours per client (pie chart)
 - Hours over time (line graph — weekly/monthly)
 - Billable vs. Non-Billable ratio
 - Utilization rate (billable hours ÷ total working hours)

5.9.5 Exportable Reports

- Export formats: **PDF, CSV, Excel**
 - Exportable by: date range, project, client, employee, billing status
 - Scheduled report delivery via email (*optional*)
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5.10 Budget & Hour Tracking

Description: Allows managers or admins to set hour budgets per project and track progress.

Requirements:

- Set estimated hour budget at project creation or edit
- Visual progress bar on project dashboard (e.g., "142 of 200 hours used")

- Automated alerts at **75%, 90%, and 100%** of budget consumed
- Alerts delivered via in-app notification and email

5.11 Billing & Invoicing

Description: Generate, manage, and track professional invoices directly from logged time data.

5.11.1 Hourly Rate Configuration

- Set billing rates at the following levels:
 - Per project
 - Per client
 - Per employee role
- Rates support **multi-currency**

5.11.2 Invoice Generation

- Select sessions (by project, date range, or individual) to include
- Mark sessions as **Billable / Non-Billable** individually
- Auto-calculate totals based on hours × rate
- Customizable invoice fields:
 - Company logo
 - Payment terms
 - Notes / memo
 - Tax fields (flat rate or percentage)

5.11.3 Invoice Status Tracking

Status	Description
Draft	Created but not yet sent
Sent	Delivered to client

Status	Description
Viewed	Client has opened the invoice
Paid	Payment received and marked
Overdue	Past due date with no payment

5.11.4 Recurring Invoices

- Create invoice templates for retainer-based clients
- Configure recurrence: weekly, bi-weekly, monthly
- Auto-generate and optionally auto-send on schedule

5.11.5 Payment Integration

- Integrations with:
 - Stripe
 - PayPal
 - QuickBooks
- Payment status syncs back to invoice automatically

5.12 Team & Manager Features

Description: Tools enabling managers to oversee, organize, and approve team time tracking activity.

5.12.1 Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

Role	Permissions
Admin	Full system access, billing, user management, integrations
Manager	Add/remove employees, assign projects, view/approve team logs, generate invoices
Employee	Log time, view own sessions and assigned projects

Role	Permissions
Client (View-Only)	View assigned project progress and invoices only

5.12.2 Employee Management

- Managers can **add, remove, and assign employees** to projects
- Employees only see projects they are assigned to
- Manager can view **all employee contributions** per project

5.12.3 Approval Workflow

- Employees **submit time logs** for manager review (daily or weekly)
- Manager can **approve, reject, or request edits** on submissions
- Rejected entries return to employee with **comments**
- Only approved entries are eligible for invoice generation

5.12.4 Team Contribution View

- Visual breakdown of each team member's hours on a shared project
- Sortable by: employee name, total hours, billable hours, last activity

5.12.5 Notifications & Reminders

- End-of-day reminder to employees to submit time logs (*configurable*)
- Manager alerts when:
 - Project budget thresholds are reached
 - Time logs are submitted for approval
 - Invoices become overdue
- Notification delivery: **in-app** and **email**

5.13 Client Portal

Description: A read-only web interface for clients to view project progress and invoices.

Requirements:

- Clients receive a **unique login** provisioned by Admin or Manager
 - Clients can view:
 - Project status and hour summaries
 - Invoices (Draft excluded; Sent and beyond visible)
 - Payment history
 - Clients **cannot** view individual employee names or internal session notes
 - Client portal accessible via **web browser only**
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5.14 Integrations

5.14.1 Calendar Sync

- **Google Calendar** and **Microsoft Outlook** integration
- Auto-suggest time entries based on calendar events
- User confirms or dismisses suggestions; no automatic logging

5.14.2 Project Management Tools

- Integrations with: **Jira, Asana, Monday.com, Trello**
- Pull in tasks/tickets as selectable time entry options
- Sync session status back to task (e.g., mark task as *In Progress*)

5.14.3 Accounting Software

- Integrations with: **QuickBooks, FreshBooks, Xero**
- Sync invoices and payments bidirectionally
- Map projects and clients to accounting chart of accounts

5.14.4 API Access

- RESTful API available for **Enterprise tier** customers
- Full documentation provided
- Supports: session creation, project management, invoice retrieval, user management

- API key management within Admin dashboard
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5.15 Security & Compliance

Requirements:

- **Single Sign-On (SSO):** Google, Microsoft, Okta support
 - **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** Required for Admin; optional for all other roles
 - **Audit Logs:** Full immutable history of all edits, deletions, approvals, and logins
 - **GDPR Compliance:**
 - User data export on request
 - Account and data deletion on request
 - Data retention policy configurable by Admin
 - **Data Encryption:** All data encrypted in transit (TLS 1.3) and at rest (AES-256)
 - **Role-based data isolation:** Users cannot access data outside their assigned scope
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5.16 UI/UX Standards

Requirements:

- **Color-coded projects** — each project assigned a unique color, reflected in widget and dashboard
 - **Dark mode and light mode** — user-selectable, with OS-level auto-detection option
 - **Drag-and-drop** session editing on dashboard
 - **Onboarding wizard** for first-time users and new account setup
 - **Responsive design** across all screen sizes and platforms
 - **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.1 AA compliance target
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6. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Performance	Timer accuracy to ±1 second; dashboard loads within 2 seconds
Availability	99.9% uptime SLA for cloud-hosted services
Scalability	Support up to 10,000 concurrent users per instance
Offline	Full timer and manual entry functionality without internet connection
Sync	Offline data syncs automatically upon reconnection with conflict resolution
Data Backup	Automated daily backups with 30-day retention minimum

7. Monetization & Tiering

Tier	Included Features
Free	1 user, 3 projects, basic timer, manual entry, simple dashboard
Pro	Unlimited projects, invoicing, reports, export, time rounding, idle detection, multi-currency
Team	All Pro features + manager tools, RBAC, approval workflows, team dashboards, client portal
Enterprise	All Team features + SSO, API access, audit logs, custom integrations, dedicated support

8. Out of Scope (v1.0)

The following features are explicitly excluded from the initial release:

- Keyboard shortcuts
- Chat bot integrations (Slack/Teams)
- AI-powered project suggestions
- AI anomaly detection
- Natural language time entry

- Predictive billing

9. Open Questions & Assumptions

Question / Assumption

- 1 What is the preferred tech stack for front-end, back-end, and database?
- 2 Will the app be self-hosted, cloud-hosted, or both?
- 3 Are there specific compliance frameworks required beyond GDPR (e.g., SOC 2, HIPAA)?
- 4 What is the target launch timeline and MVP scope?
- 5 Will the client portal require its own branded subdomain per organization?
- 6 Is there a maximum number of employees per Manager account?
- 7 Should the mobile app support the full feature set or a reduced subset?